



WINCHESTER MODEL 1887

BROWNING
M1917FN BROWNING
HP 35

- 1883** Thomas G. Bennett of Winchester visits Browning and buys the patent of his single-shot rifle outright for \$8,000.
- 1887** The lever-action Winchester Model 1887, designed by John Browning, is the first successful repeating shotgun.
- 1897** Browning signs a contract giving FN the right to manufacture and sell his .32in automatic pistol.

- 1900** Browning is granted a US patent for a semiautomatic rifle, which becomes the Remington Model 8 in the US and the FN Model 1900 elsewhere.
- 1917** The launch of the Browning M1917 heavy machine-gun is too late for widespread use in World War I, but the weapon will be used for decades afterward.

- 1918** The M1918 light machine-gun, also known as the Browning Automatic Rifle (BAR), begins its long service life of more than 40 years.
- 1935** Derived from Browning's last design, the FN Browning HP 35 also incorporates the work of FN designer Dieudonné Saive.

minute and used air-cooling to compensate for the heat produced by the action. The weapon sold in markets from Russia to countries in South America and saw service in the Spanish-American War (1898) and World War I. Having made a mark with this large automatic gun, Browning designed an automatic pistol. This type of weapon had been developed in Europe by manufacturers such as Mauser, but Browning was the first American to enter this market. First, he offered his design to Winchester, but he asked for a royalty on each weapon made, rather

than the single-fee payment he had accepted in the past. Winchester turned down Browning's request, and the designer instead went to the Belgian company Fabrique Nationale (FN). FN accepted, and its Browning-designed M1900 semiautomatic pistol (see p.167) was produced between 1900 and 1911. This was the beginning of a partnership that lasted until Browning's death.

In the final decades of his life, Browning continued his work, concentrating especially on automatic weapons. He produced such guns as

the Model 1917 (see p.190), a powerful recoil-operated machine-gun cooled with a water jacket, and the Browning Automatic Rifle (see p.194), a light machine-gun first produced in 1918. The latter remained in production, in various forms and via a number of manufacturers, into the 1950s. A tireless innovator, Browning continued working into his last years and died while working on a self-loading pistol at his bench in the FN factory in Liège, Belgium. His name lives on as the creator of some of the world's most successful firearms.

▼ PUBLIC ENEMIES

Leaning out of a car window, Stephen Dorff, playing Homer Van Meter, fires a Browning Automatic Rifle at FBI agent Purvis and his men in the 2009 film *Public Enemies*. The movie is about the notorious 1930s bank robber John Dillinger.

